

# ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS REGISTER

## VertexOne Digital Services

**Document Owner:** Junior GRC Analyst

**Reviewed By:** CISO

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**Document Type:** ISMS / Corrective Action Supporting Record

### 1. Purpose

This register documents the root-cause analysis performed for findings identified during the VertexOne Digital Services audit and assessment activities.

The objective is to identify the underlying causes of each finding rather than addressing only the immediate symptom, thereby supporting effective corrective and preventive actions.

### 2. Root Cause Analysis : F-001

#### F-001 : Backup Restoration Never Tested

**Finding Classification:** Major Nonconformity

**Analysis Method:** 5 Whys

#### Problem Statement

Backup restoration testing had not been performed, resulting in the organization lacking evidence that backups could be successfully restored within defined recovery requirements.

#### 5 Whys Analysis

##### Why 1 : Why hasn't backup restoration been tested?

No one has scheduled the restoration test.

##### Why 2 : Why hasn't it been scheduled?

The procedure has no assigned owner with a defined due date.

##### Why 3 : Why does the procedure lack an owner?

Ownership was assumed rather than formally assigned during documentation.

##### Why 4 : Why was ownership assumed?

New procedures were not routed through a formal ownership sign-off step.

#### **Why 5 : Root Cause**

The Document Control Procedure did not require explicit owner sign-off when creating or approving new procedures.

#### **Root Cause Statement**

The underlying root cause was a weakness in the document-control process that allowed procedures to be created without formally establishing accountable ownership.

#### **Corrective Action Link**

Update the Document Control Procedure to require explicit owner sign-off for all newly created procedures and complete the first backup restoration test.

### **3. Root Cause Analysis : F-005**

#### **F-005 : Inconsistent Vulnerability Scanning**

**Finding Classification:** Major Nonconformity

**Analysis Method:** Fishbone Analysis

#### **Problem Statement**

Scheduled vulnerability scans were not consistently completed, resulting in gaps in vulnerability monitoring.

#### **Contributing Factors**

##### **People**

- No individual was explicitly accountable for confirming that each scheduled weekly scan had successfully completed.

##### **Process**

- No escalation process existed when a scheduled scan failed to execute.

##### **Technology**

- The scanning tool's scheduling configuration did not provide adequate failure alerting.

##### **Environment**

- A tool configuration change coincided with the period in which scans were missed.

## **Root Cause Statement**

The root cause was a combination of insufficient technical alerting and an absent process-level escalation mechanism.

A single-dimension corrective action would not have adequately addressed the issue because both the technology and process weaknesses contributed to the missed scans.

## **Corrective Action Link**

Configure automated missed-scan alerting and assign an accountable weekly reviewer responsible for confirming scan completion.

## **4. Root Cause Analysis : F-002**

### **F-002 : Overdue Privileged Access Review**

**Finding Classification:** Minor Nonconformity

**Analysis Method:** 5 Whys : Abbreviated

## **Problem Statement**

The required privileged access review was completed after its expected review date.

## **Root Cause Statement**

The reviewer's recurring calendar reminder was not re-established following a personnel change, resulting in the review becoming overdue.

## **Corrective Action Link**

Complete the overdue privileged access review and re-establish the recurring calendar reminder.

## **5. Root Cause Analysis : F-003**

### **F-003 : Awareness Completion Below Target**

**Finding Classification:** Minor Nonconformity

**Analysis Method:** Process Analysis

## **Problem Statement**

Employee security awareness training completion remained below the organization's defined target.

### **Root Cause Statement**

No automated escalation mechanism existed to identify and escalate employees who remained overdue on required security awareness training.

### **Corrective Action Link**

Implement manager escalation at 30 days overdue for employees who have not completed required training.

### **Effectiveness Consideration**

Training completion should continue to be monitored against the defined target to verify that the corrective action produces sustained improvement.

## **6. Root Cause Analysis : F-004**

### **F-004 : Incomplete Supplier Security Reviews**

**Finding Classification:** Minor Nonconformity

**Analysis Method:** Process Analysis

### **Problem Statement**

Two required vendor security addenda remained incomplete during the assessment.

### **Root Cause Statement**

Limited legal review capacity delayed processing of the remaining two vendor contracts and prevented timely completion of the required supplier security documentation.

### **Corrective Action Link**

Complete the remaining two vendor security addenda and ensure the completed agreements are formally reviewed and retained.

## 7. Root Cause Summary

| Finding | Classification      | Analysis Method      | Root Cause Summary                                                                     |
|---------|---------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| F-001   | Major Nonconformity | 5 Whys               | Document control did not require explicit owner sign-off for newly created procedures. |
| F-005   | Major Nonconformity | Fishbone Analysis    | Missing technical alerting combined with absent process escalation.                    |
| F-002   | Minor Nonconformity | 5 Whys : Abbreviated | Recurring review reminder was not re-established after personnel change.               |
| F-003   | Minor Nonconformity | Process Analysis     | No automated escalation existed for overdue training completion.                       |
| F-004   | Minor Nonconformity | Process Analysis     | Limited legal review capacity delayed supplier security reviews.                       |

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## 8. Conclusion

The root-cause analysis indicates that the identified findings were primarily associated with weaknesses in **process ownership, escalation, monitoring, and capacity management**, rather than isolated individual errors.

Corrective actions should therefore address the underlying process weaknesses and include effectiveness monitoring to confirm that the issues do not recur.

**Prepared By:** Junior GRC Analyst

**Reviewed By:** CISO

**Status:** Reviewed

**Organization:** VertexOne Digital Services